Character, Calling & Conviction



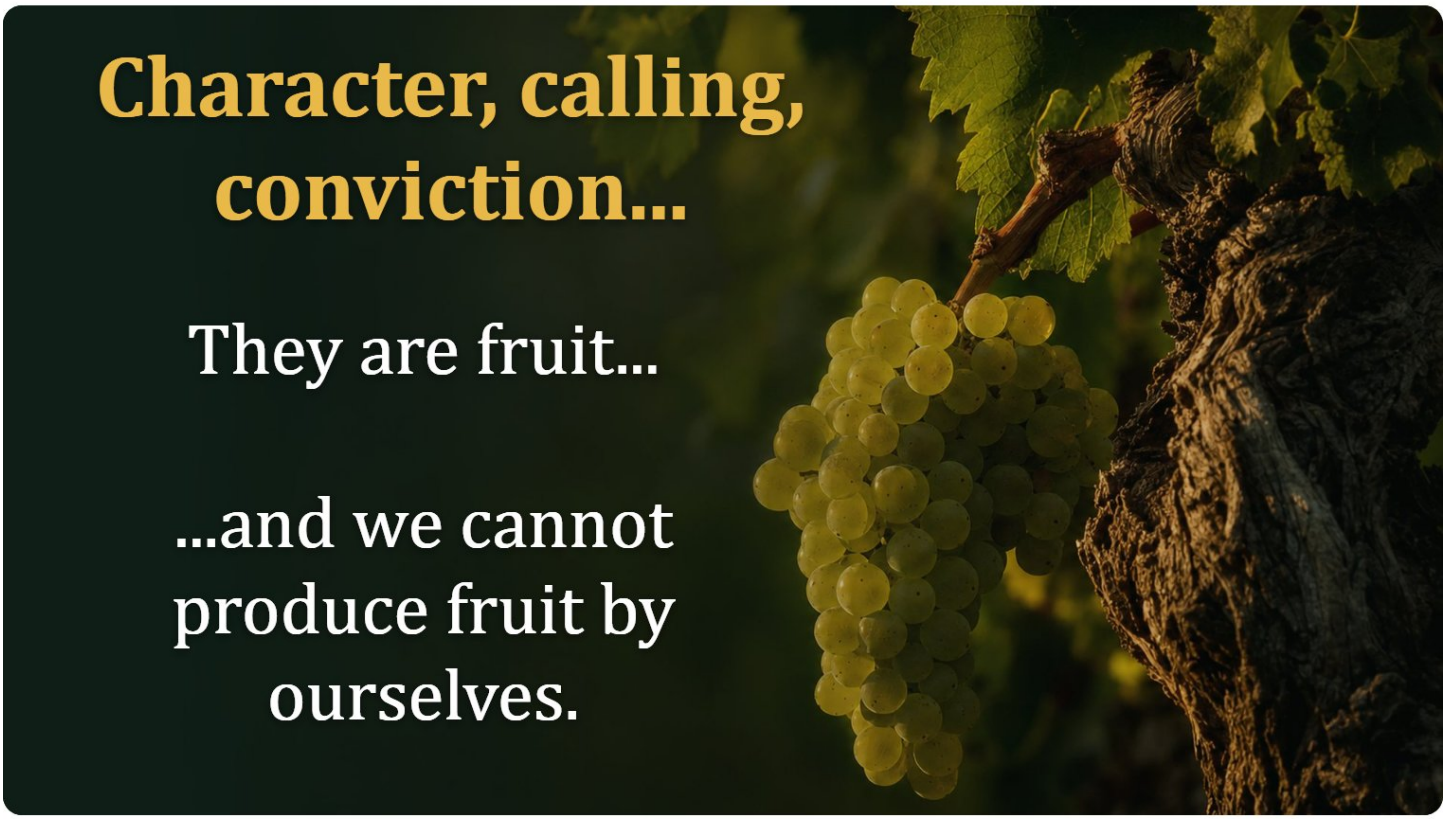


- Apart from Jesus, we can do nothing that has eternal value.
- Jesus really meant *nothing*—not “a little less,” but “of no lasting worth.”
- John 15:5 – “Apart from me you can do nothing.”
- Question: Where am I still trying to do ministry “apart from” Jesus?

Apart from me you can do NOTHING.

JOHN 15:1 (NIV)

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- Character, calling, and conviction are not self-improvement projects; they are fruit that only come from abiding in Jesus.
- “Apart in Me you can do nothing.” (John 15:5 – vine, branches, much fruit)
- Three years with Jesus—every sermon, every miracle—still did not produce the disciples’ character, calling, and conviction by itself.
- Question: Have you been trying to grow character, calling, or conviction on your own, instead of receiving them as fruit from abiding in Him?

Locked doors



Conviction?
Character?
Calling?



But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth.

ACTS 1:8 (NIV)

The disciples received power and it brought prison, conflict and weakness.

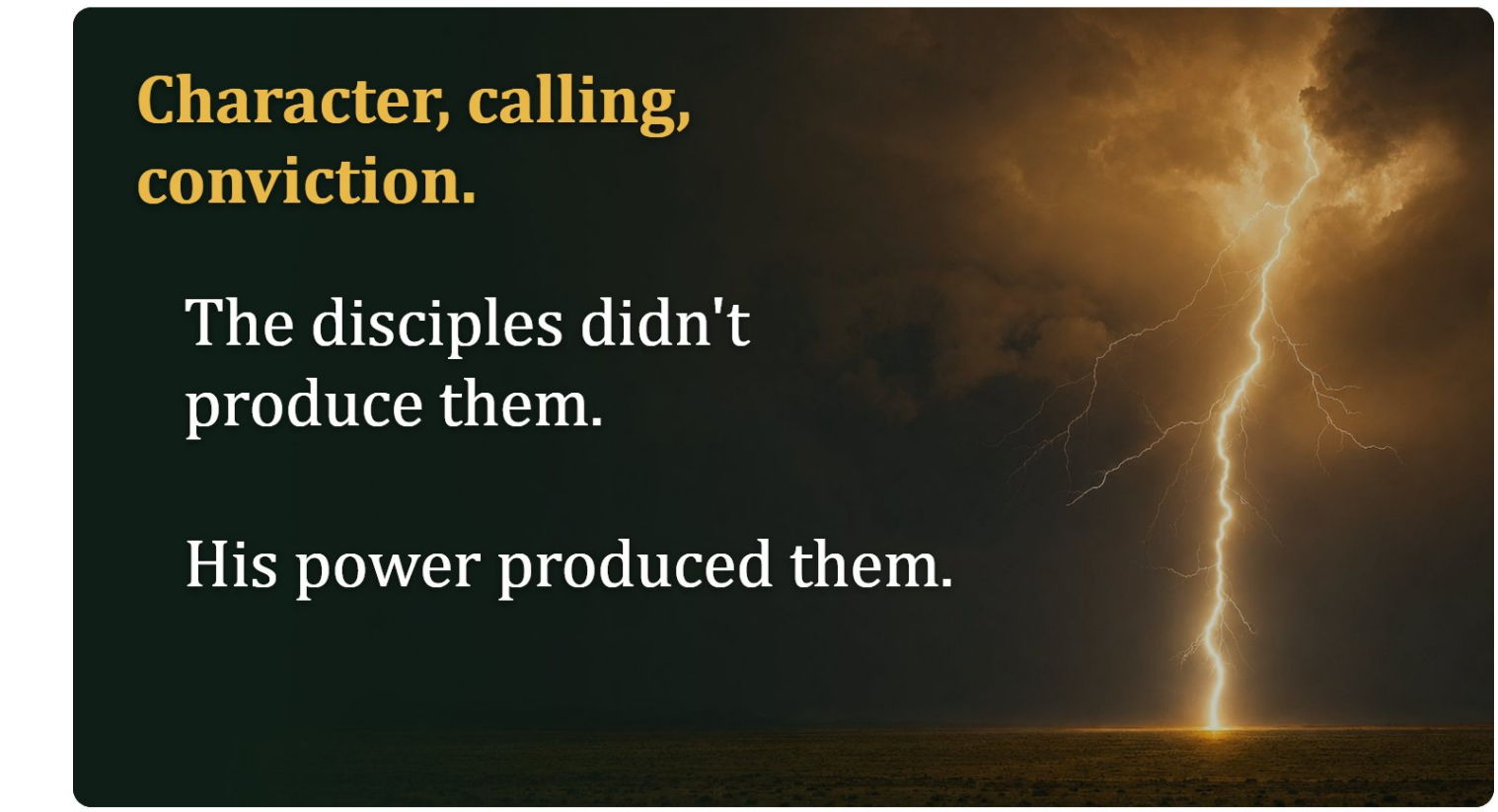
Don't expect it to look any different.



Character, calling, conviction.

The disciples didn't produce them.

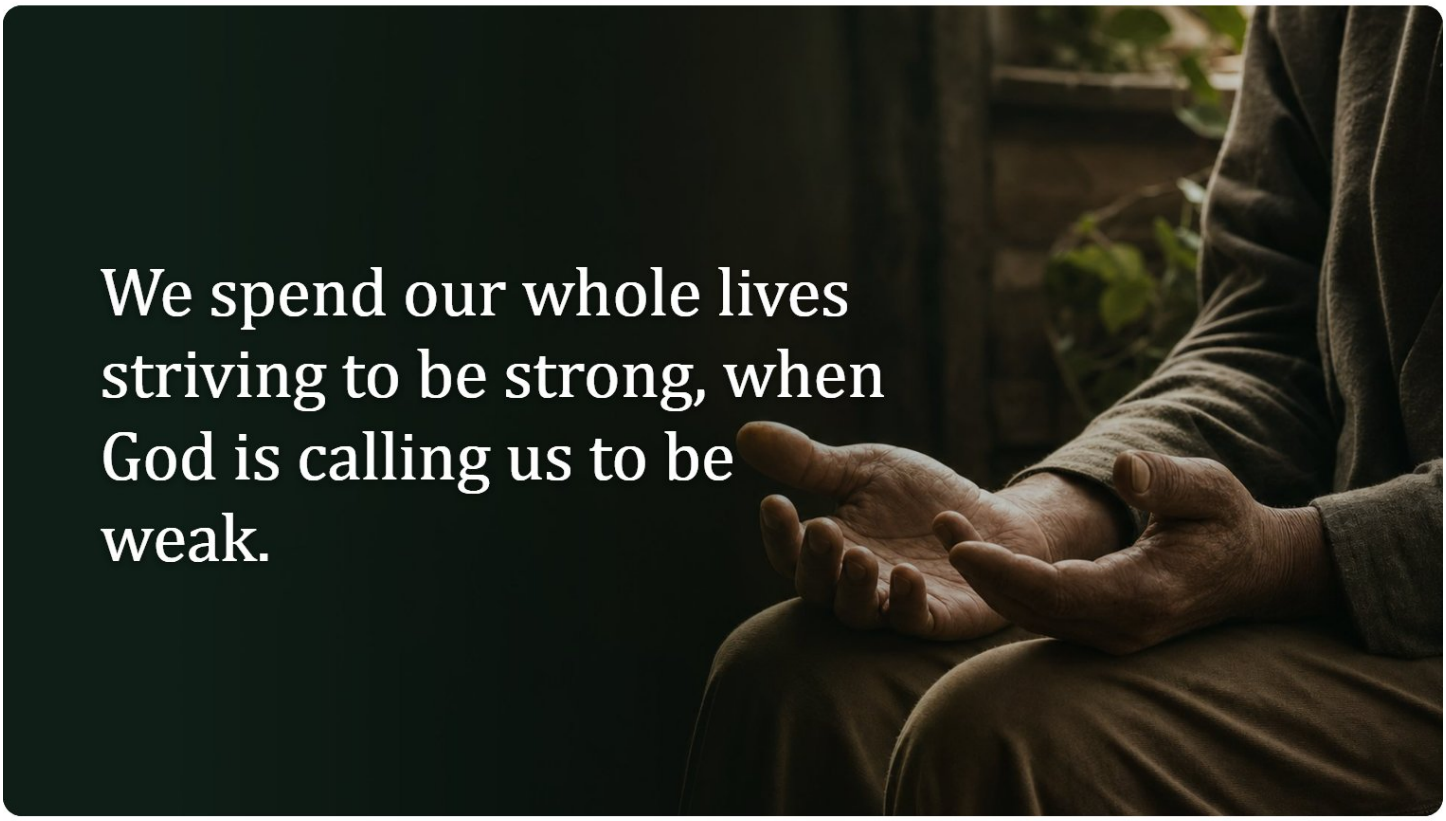
His power produced them.



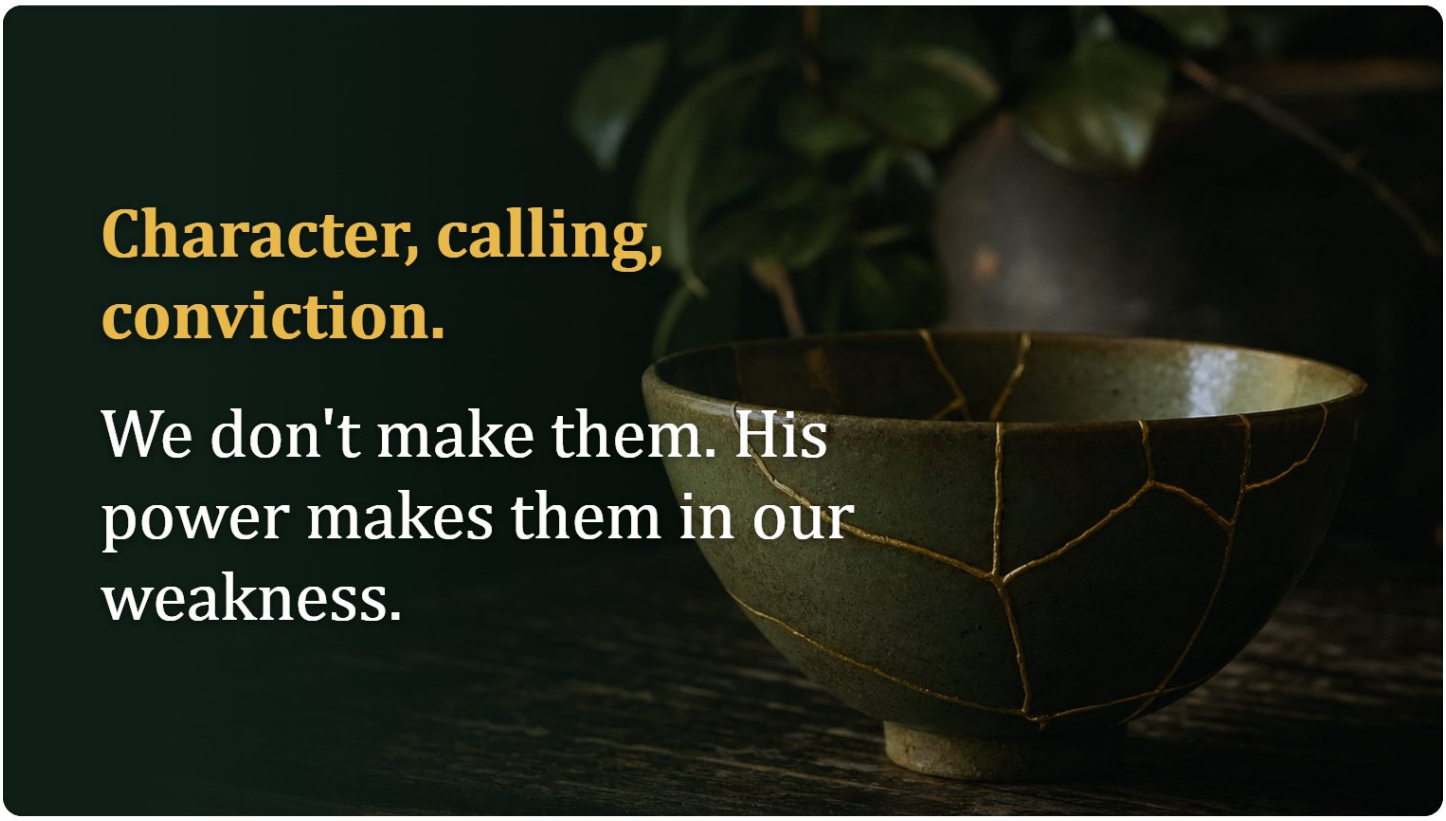
His power isn't about how we change ourselves.

It's about what He makes us into.




We spend our whole lives striving to be strong, when God is calling us to be weak.


Are you broken?



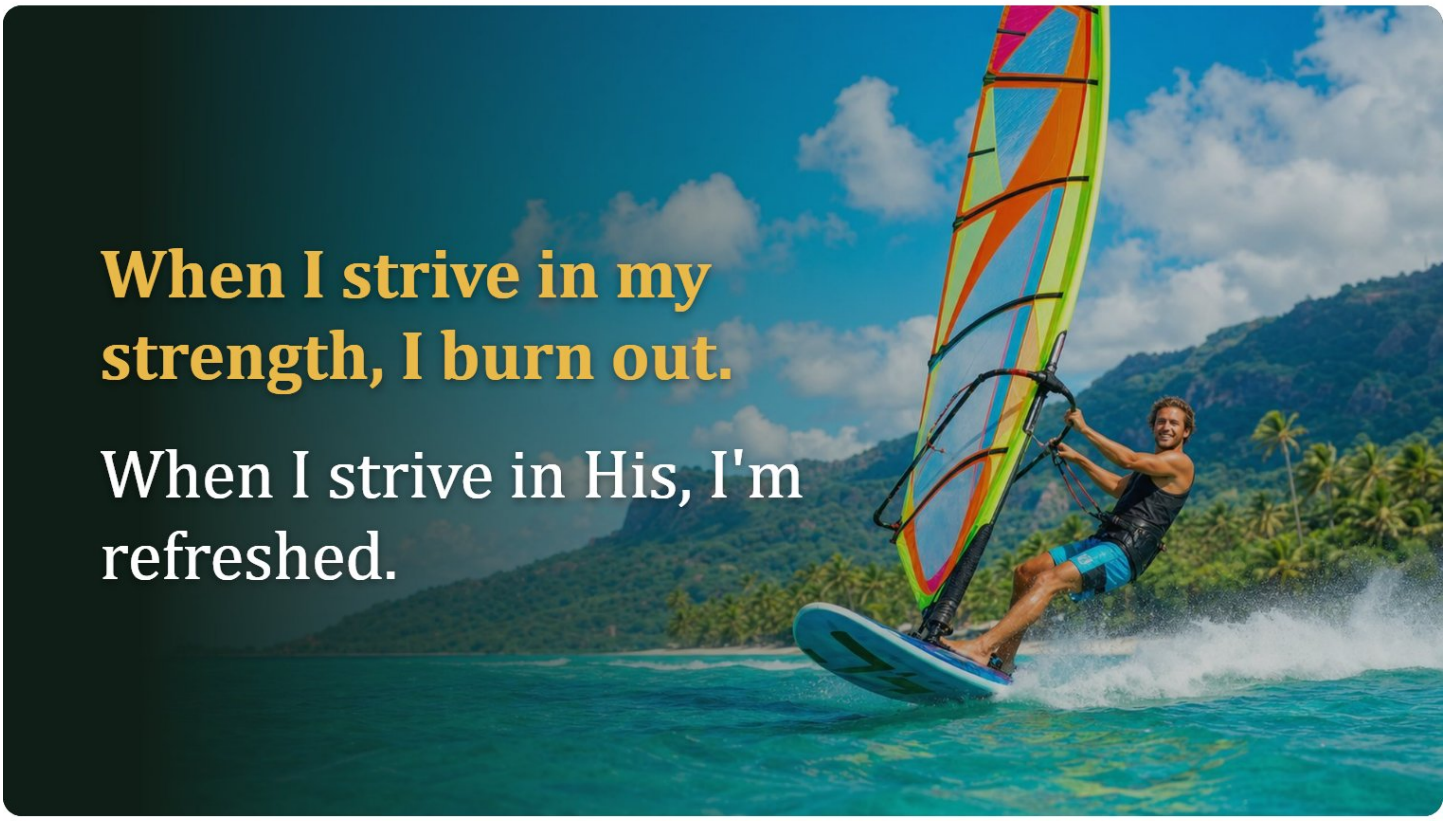
Character, calling, conviction.

We don't make them. His power makes them in our weakness.



3,000 to 250,000

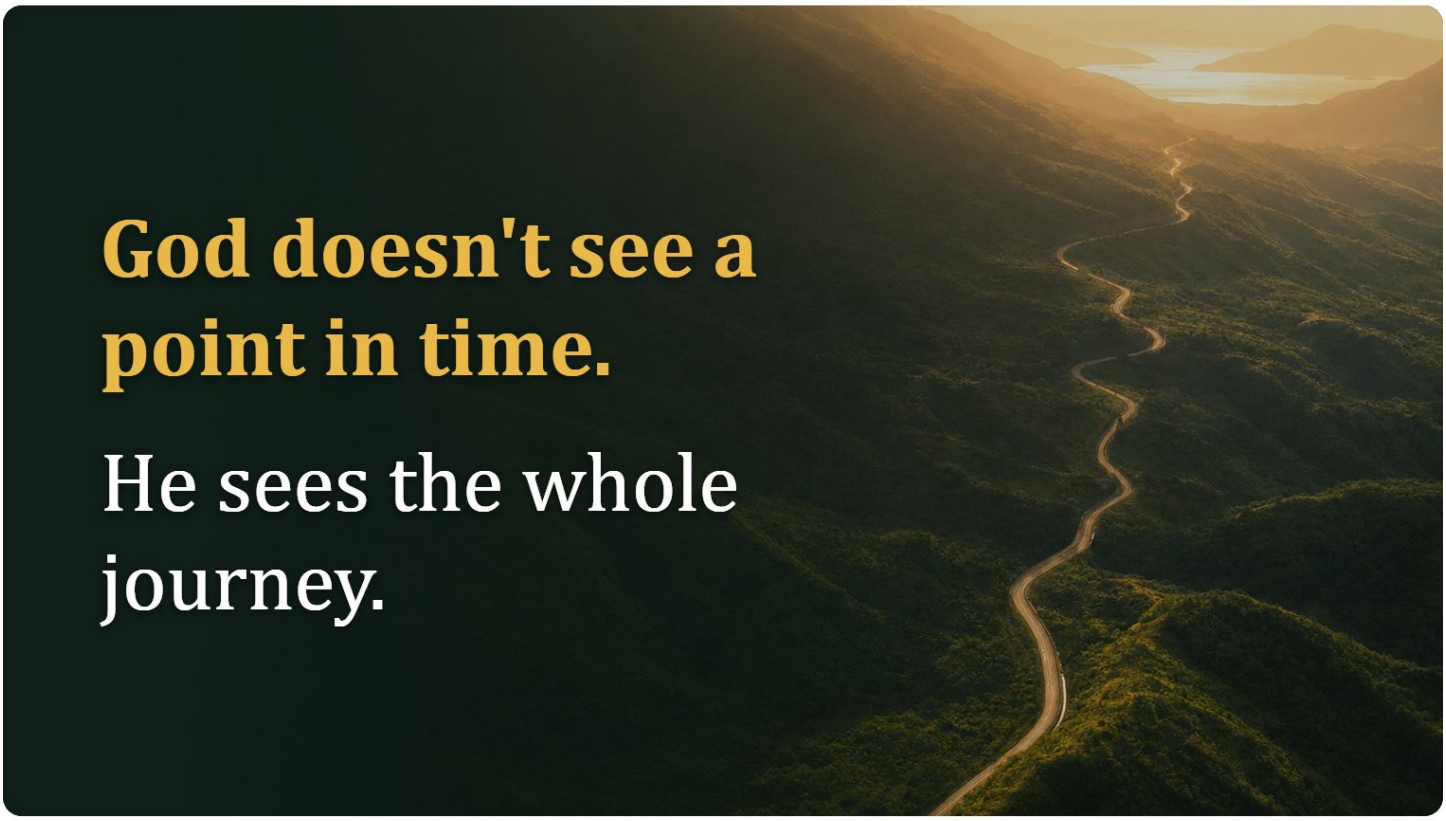
meals a week


When I strive in my strength, I burn out.
When I strive in His, I'm refreshed.


If I can do it myself, it isn't faith.

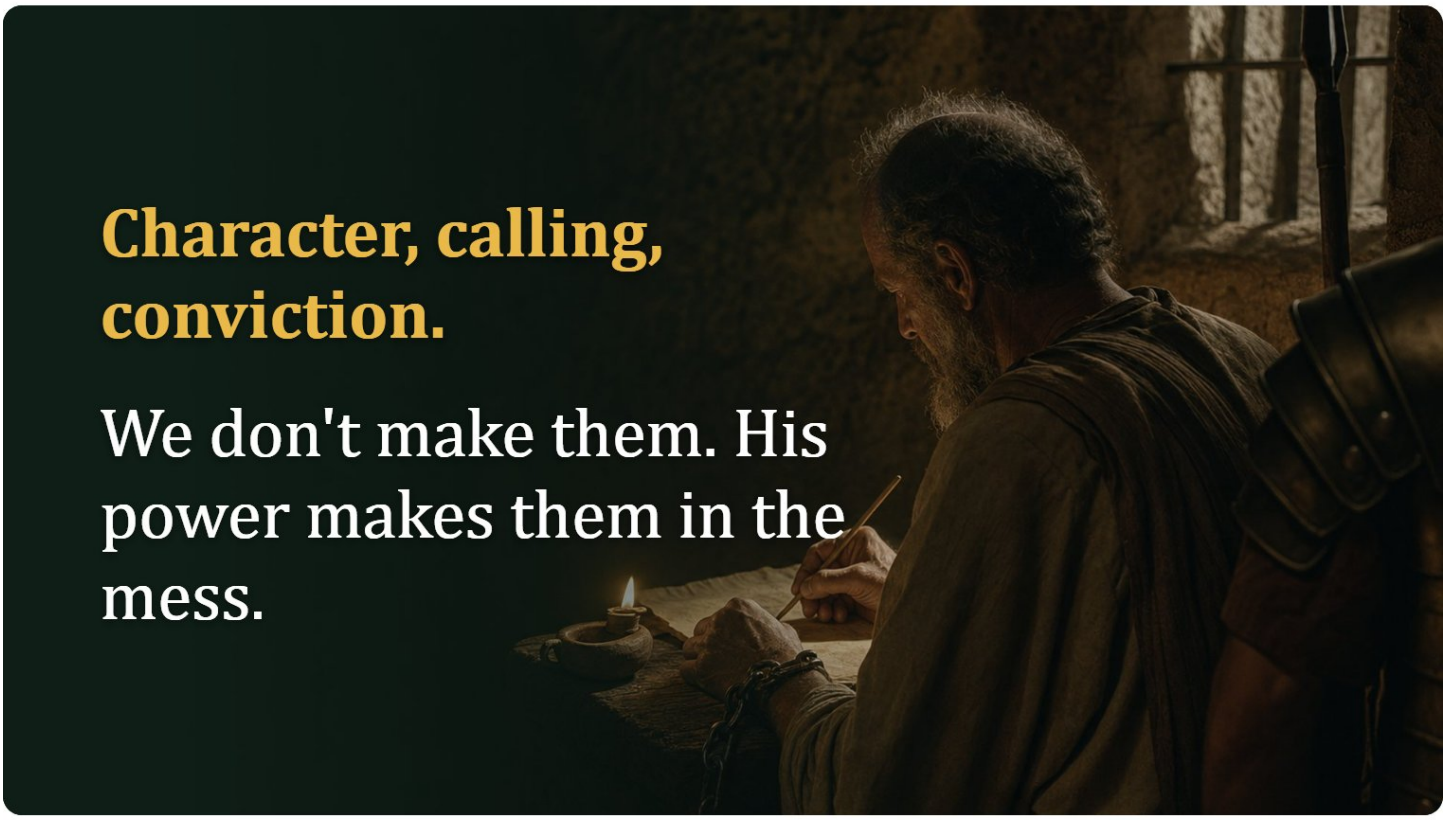

Ministry is messy, and there's beauty in the mess.


I find God's voice in the doing, not just the waiting.



God doesn't see a point in time.

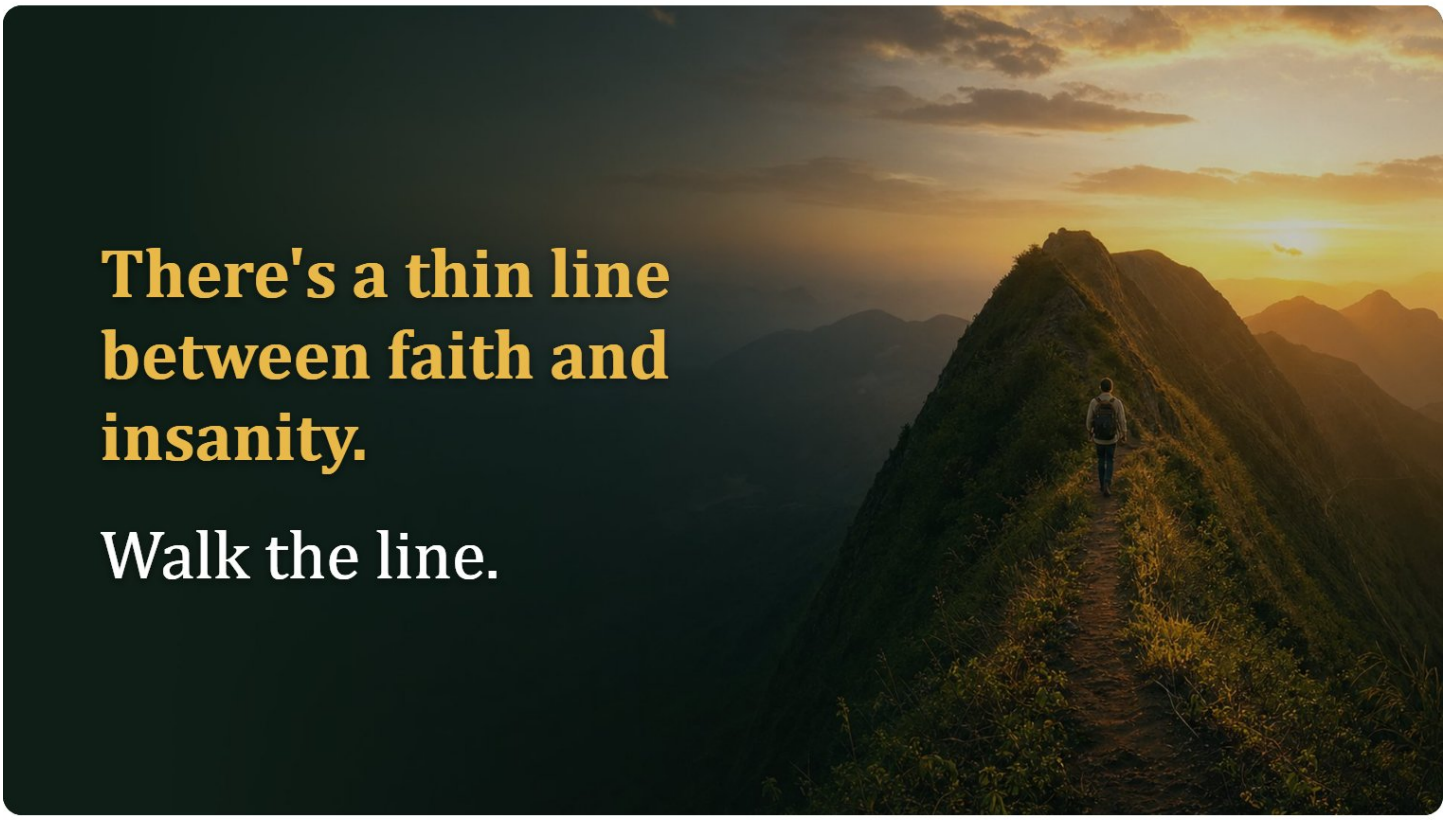
He sees the whole journey.

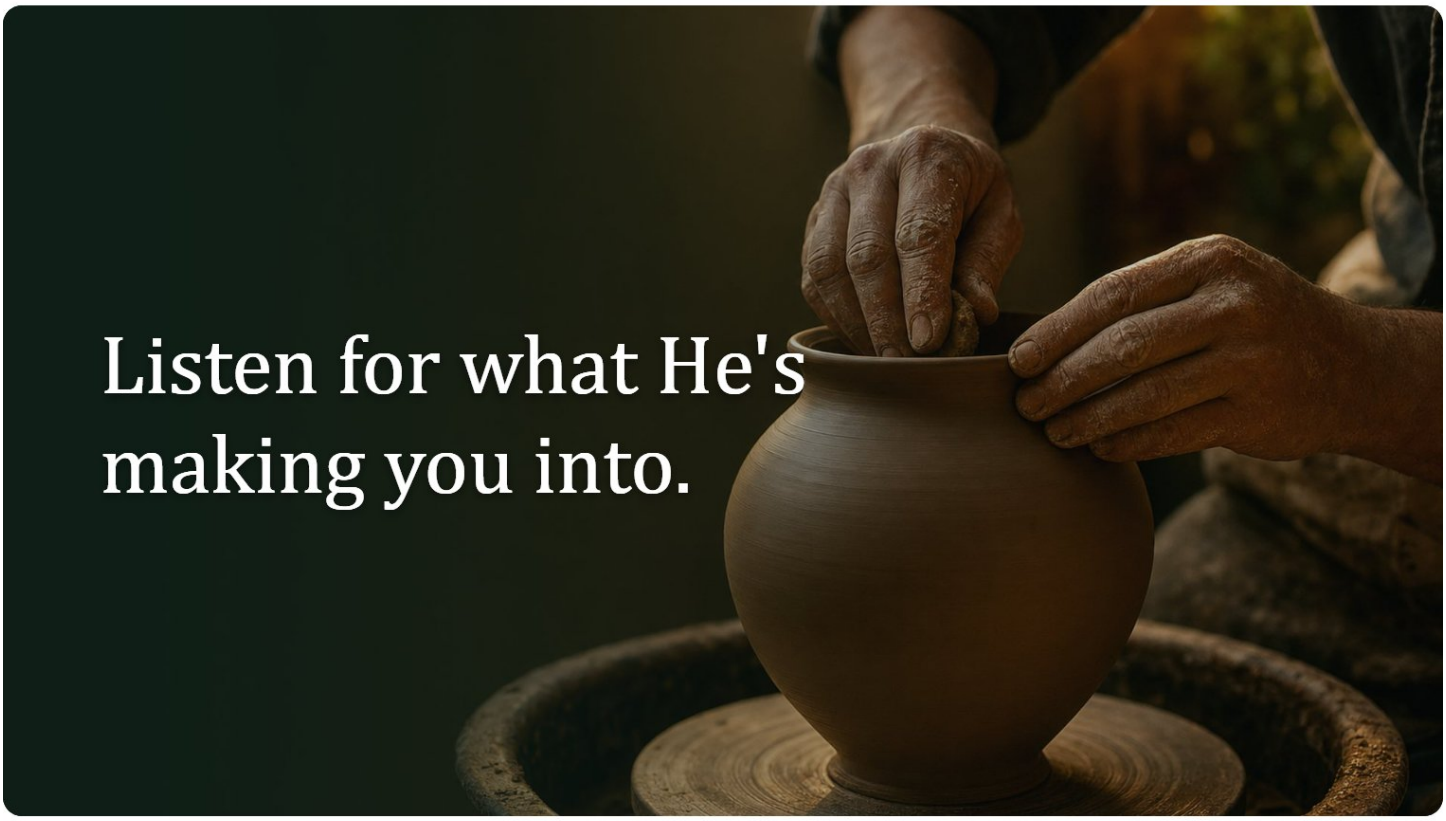


Character, calling, conviction.

We don't make them. His power makes them in the mess.


The mess is where the
power lives.


There's a thin line
between faith and
insanity.
Walk the line.


Listen for what He's
making you into.